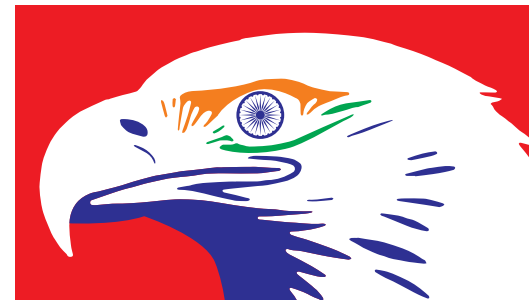
WHO HIRES H-1B HOLDERS

A look at top employers of skilled overseas talent in the US

EMPLOYERS WITH MOST H-1B VISA STAFF (Data for 2025, till June 30)

Amazon.com Services LLC	10,044
Tata Consultancy Services Ltd	5,505
Microsoft Corporation	5,189
Meta Platforms	5,123
Apple Inc.	4,202
Google LLC	4,181
Cognizant Technology Solution	2,493
JPMorgan Chase and Co.	2,440
Walmart Associates Inc	2,390
Deloitte Consulting LLP	2,353



INDIAN COMPANIES WITH MOST H-1B VISA STAFF (FY24)

Infosys	8,137
Tata Consultancy Services	7,566
HCL America	2,952
LTIMindtree	2,136
Wipro	1,636
Tech Mahindra Americas	1,199
L&T Technology Services	351

Source: US DHS, US Citizenship and Immigration Services, Bloomberg, Emkay Research

comparable to US workers. While the median wage for an IT worker in the US is $122,000, they argue that the added costs for visas, various compliances and filing fees further increase the overall cost of H-1B visa-holders, making them just as expensive as a local recruit.

"Salaries are at par with local hires. Moreover, H-1B workers are a mere decimal point of the overall US workforce," Nasscom said in a statement. "Over the years, Indian and India-centric companies operating in the US have significantly reduced their dependencies on H-1B visas and steadily increased their local hiring. As per available data, H-1B issued to the leading India and India-centric companies has decreased from 14,792 in 2015 to 10,162 in 2024." Indian firms are also spending over $1 billion on local upskilling and hiring in the US, it added. Till then, the H-1B visa bridges a critical skills gap in the US.

Regarding the immediate effects of the US move, Aditya Narayan Mishra, MD and CEO of staffing firm CIEL HR Services, says, "While Indian IT firms will adapt their business models to manage costs, in the short term, project timelines for US clients may be stretched due to limited onsite availability." He, however, expects a stronger shift toward alternative talent models, remote contracting, offshore delivery and gig-based work.

A NEW NORMAL?

That argument finds favour with most experts. The COVID-19 pandemic, while being a major disruptor, also convincingly demonstrated that work could be accomplished from anywhere. Alongside, there has also been an increase in the number of global capability centres (GCCs), or offshore units MNCs have set up in India to perform strategic, technical and operational functions. They have been the bright spot in the Indian IT landscape of late even as traditional IT services companies are struggling with global uncertainty over trade tariffs that have affected IT spend by customers. "GCCs demonstrated that a lot of research and development, and high value work can also be done anywhere globally. That has changed the tone of global sourcing in the Indian services category," says an industry expert.

The number of GCCs in the country has risen from 1,285 in FY19 to 1,750 in FY25. While India is home to large GCCs whose staff run into thousands, this recent spell of growth is largely driven by mid-market GCCs employing up to 1,000 employees which are established by parent organisations with annual revenues between $100 million and $1 billion. "If anything, offshoring will increase because of the visa restrictions," says former Infosys board member V. Balakrishnan. "So, overall, it will be positive. The only challenge is the unemployment rate in the US is high. So whether this [H-1B restriction] is the first step or there will be a series of steps is what we have to watch for." That uncertainty likely also extends to offshoring tech jobs, given how the Trump-led administration has frowned on taking manufacturing jobs elsewhere. Case in point: Trump's objection to Apple making its phones in India.

The bigger challenge the IT sector is facing, however, isn't so much about restrictive policies. "The industry is today quite mature. It has seen multiple structural shifts earlier and will probably find ways to thrive under the newer constraints," says the expert cited earlier. But the key question many are bracing for is whether the H-1B visa restriction is only the first salvo from the US. ■